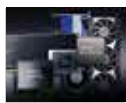




Robots runs 5k

Cassie, the bipedal robot, that's all legs, runs 5kms on a single charge without any tether! <https://digit.in/aug21-11>



AMD's new CPUs and GPUs

AMD's next-gen Zen 4 Ryzen CPUs and RDNA 3 Radeon RX GPUs are on track for a 2022 launch. <https://digit.in/aug21-12>

WHAT IS IT?

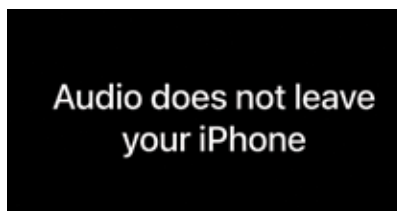
Apple announced that the data processing for Siri will now happen on the device that it is running on. In a press release, Apple wrote, "For many requests, Siri processing is also moving on device, enabling requests to be processed without an internet connection, such as launching apps, setting timers and alarms, changing settings, or controlling music."

What this means is that many basic requests like opening apps and the like will be processed offline and will not be routed through to the Apple servers and back, as it used to happen until now. This means that the requests would be processed much faster than before, and this would increase the privacy of the users' data, as it will now mostly be there on the device and never leave in many use cases. This also means that you will be able to use Siri, albeit in a limiting way, offline.

ARE YOU SAFE? APPLE SAYS, YES!

While talking about this new development, which is set to roll out with iOS 15, the Apple executives seemed pretty confident that this move will take user privacy one step further. First off, the reason stated for the introduction of this change was that the iPads and iPhones, the latest ones, come equipped with Apple's neural engine, which is capable of handling tasks that would require 'racks of servers'. And then, there was the big definition of what this move is exactly. Apple said, "we are moving all automatic speech recognition models for Siri to run entirely on-device." The text that appeared on the screen was as important as this statement, as it read, "Audio does not leave your iPhone".

Well, that's great! But don't start celebrating yet and saying all your passwords all loud and clear for your now truly smart yet dumb device to hear. We are



Thanks for leaving me alone. I guess?

not saying that the company is out for your passwords, but you know what we mean.

THERE'S MORE TO WHAT MEETS THE EYE

The debate for voice data collection has been raging on for almost half a decade now, with it catching the most momentum in the last couple of years. Just hop on to the internet and type the keywords 'voice assistants recording you'. And we bet you will think twice after voicing your next command at your AI assistant, which by now would be present in almost all our homes. Well, it is not bad as it seems. The companies are not going to blackmail you on the back of your voice recordings. But why give them information for free and without consent!

The Federal Trade Commission, a USA government body, has gone to the extent of even putting out guidelines for end-users, with the title, 'How To Secure Your Voice Assistant and Protect Your Privacy'. And the first sentence of this fairly crisp article sums it all up pretty beautifully. It says, "Your wish is



Securing router... Check.

their command". That's how it ideally should be, but as it turns out, in many cases, it is not it. Regardless of the fact whether you know or not, there are chances that your device with an AI assistant on it has recorded your voice at some point in time and sent it to the servers, where it was played over and over to train the AI, making it "better for you".

APPLE THE MESSIAH?

If we take what was told in WWDC with regards to audio processing happening on the device for Siri, there could not have been a better thing to have been done by Apple, given the times that we are living in. As weird as it may sound, it is actually good for you for the most part. Given that the executives of Apple said it explicitly



Give me a break, Mr Call-e!

that most of the audio is going to stay on your iPhone or iPad when you talk to Siri means that if nothing, it is a step in the right direction.

What more could you ask for? In a world where everyone is out there to get your data, as soon as you press the button to connect to the internet on your device, you keep whatever you get. We are not asking you to submit to the mercy of these tech giants. We never will. You are the consumer, and you should exercise your rights when necessary. But sometimes it is necessary to appreciate the companies at times, when they say, if not do, something good. Who knows, after the release of iOS 15, and subsequently, this new tech may come to be another predatory step. But as things stand as of now, in theory, we can see the rays of the sun rising in a new tomorrow, with a potentially better connected yet private world. **d**

Source: Apple

Source: FTC